

WORKSHOP CONCEPT NOTE

Joint Design Thinking Workshop for the Baseline Research Design, Workplan and Digital Product Requirements

Project: Digital Accessibility and Uganda Sign Language Digitalisation Project

Date: Thursday, 27 August 2026

Time: 8:30 AM - 5:00 PM

Venue: 8TECH Offices, Kasangati

Organised by: 8TECH and UNAD

Duration: One Day - Full Day Physical Workshop

1. Background

Following the completion of the project inception meeting held on **19 August 2026**, the project is now transitioning from the inception and planning phase into implementation.

The inception meeting provided an opportunity for UCC, UNAD, 8TECH and the wider project team to establish a common understanding of the project objectives, expected results, implementation approach, roles and responsibilities, and the immediate priorities for commencement of project activities. As part of the agreed next steps, several key technical and implementation documents are required to guide the project. These include the **Baseline Research Design, Detailed Workplan, and Software Requirements Specification (SRS) for the planned digital products**. The project methodology also provides for collaborative technical engagement and validation of the research, implementation and digital product development approaches. It is therefore proposed that the project team convene a **full-day physical technical workshop** to collectively review, refine and validate these key components before commencement of the related implementation activities.

The workshop will bring together the project implementation teams from **UCC, UNAD and 8TECH**, as well as the relevant **Uganda Sign Language experts, researchers and UNAD team members who will support data collection**. Their participation will be particularly important in ensuring that the research approach, data collection processes and proposed digital solutions are technically sound, accessible and responsive to the needs of Deaf persons and other intended users.

2. Rationale for the Workshop

While the inception meeting established the overall direction of the project, the next stage requires the team to translate this understanding into clear, coordinated and technically validated implementation arrangements.

3. Workshop Goal

To collectively review, validate and refine the key technical and implementation documents required to commence the project implementation in a coordinated and technically sound manner.

4. Workshop Objectives

The specific objectives of the workshop are to:

- i. **Baseline Research Design:** Review and validate the baseline research design, including the research questions, methodology, target groups, sampling approach, data collection methods, tools and implementation arrangements
- ii. **Data Collection Preparation:** Review the proposed data collection approach and agree on the roles, responsibilities and preparations required for the UNAD team, researchers and data collection personnel.
- iii. **Uganda Sign Language Technical Input:** Obtain technical input from Sign Language experts to ensure that the research process and subsequent digital products appropriately consider Uganda Sign Language, Deaf community perspectives, terminology, accessibility and usability
- iv. **Project Workplan:** Review and refine the detailed workplan, including activities, timelines, milestones, responsible parties, dependencies and key deliverables.
- v. **Digital Products:** Review the Software Requirements Specification (SRS) for the planned digital products and ensure that the proposed functional and technical requirements are aligned with the project's objectives and user needs.
- vi. **Coordination and Implementation:** Establish a common understanding among teams on the immediate implementation priorities, coordination mechanisms and next steps.

5. Expected Workshop Outputs

By the end of the workshop, the team is expected to have achieved the following:

- i. Reviewed and validated Baseline Research Design.
- ii. Agreed on the baseline data collection approach and preparations.
- iii. Clarified the roles of Sign Language experts and the UNAD data collection team.
- iv. Reviewed and refined the detailed project workplan.
- v. Reviewed and provided technical/user input into the SRS for the planned digital products.
- vi. Identified gaps, issues and dependencies requiring further attention.
- vii. Agreed on responsibilities and timelines for finalising the key documents.
- viii. Agreed on immediate implementation priorities and next steps.
- ix. Developed a clear action matrix assigning responsibilities and deadlines.

6. Proposed Workshop Methodology

The workshop will use a participatory and practical approach rather than a presentation-only format.

The methodology will include:

- i. **Brief presentations** to introduce the respective technical areas.
- ii. **Plenary discussions** to obtain inputs from all participating institutions.
- iii. **Technical review sessions** for the research design, workplan and SRS.
- iv. **Group discussions**, where necessary, to address specific technical areas.
- v. **Question-and-answer sessions** to clarify issues.
- vi. **Joint validation and consensus building** on proposed approaches.
- vii. **Action planning** to document agreed responsibilities and timelines.

The workshop will particularly emphasise **user-centred and accessibility considerations**, ensuring that the perspectives of Deaf persons and Uganda Sign Language experts are incorporated into both the research process and digital product development.

7. Proposed Participants

The workshop should bring together 20 representatives from the three core project partners and relevant technical/resource persons.

No.	Institution/ Team	Participants/Expertise Required	Main Role
1.	UCC	Project Manager	Project oversight
2.	UNAD	Sign Language Experts (2)	UGSL technical input and validation
3.	UNAD	Project Officer	Research and field data collection planning
4.	UNAD	Finance Officer	Research and field data collection planning
5.	UNAD	Sign Language Officer	User and accessibility perspectives
6.	8TECH	Project Lead/ Chief Technology Officer	Project Oversight
7.	8TECH	Senior Managers (2-COO&BM)	Project Oversight and Coordination
8.	8TECH	Lead Researcher / Project Manager	Workshop Coordination and Baseline research design
9.	8TECH	Software/Systems Developer(s) - (3)	SRS and technical requirements
10.	8TECH	Researcher Team (4)	Baseline research design and methodology
11.	8TECH	PRO and PWD Ambassador (2)	Media

12.	8TECH	Finance & Admin (2)	Research and field data collection planning
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The final list of names can be confirmed by each institution ahead of the workshop.

8. Proposed Workshop Programme

Venue: 8TECH Offices (Ground Floor) | Full Day Physical Workshop

Time	Session	Lead/Responsible
8:30 - 9:00	Registration and Networking	8TECH / Secretariat
9:00 - 9:15	Prayer, Opening, Welcome and Introductions	UNAD / 8TECH
9:15 - 9:30	Recap of Inception Meeting: Key Agreements and Immediate Next Steps. Overview of Workshop Objectives, Expected Outputs and Approach	Project Coordinator
9:30 - 10:30	Session I: Review of Baseline Research Design - objectives, research questions, methodology, target groups, sampling and data collection approach	Lead Researcher
10:30 - 11:00	Health Break	Admin
11:00 - 12:30	Session II: Review of data collection tools and Field Implementation Planning - tools, roles, Sign Language considerations, data quality, logistics and responsibilities	Lead Researcher
12:30 - 1:00	Plenary Discussion and Agreement on Baseline Research Design	All
1:00 - 2:00	Lunch Break	—
2:00 - 3:00	Session IV: Review of SRS and Planned Digital Products - user requirements, functional requirements, accessibility, UGSL considerations, technical requirements and validation	Software Lead
3:00 - 4:00	Session III: Review of Detailed Project Workplan - activities, timelines, milestones, responsibilities, dependencies and deliverables	Project Coordinator
4:00 - 4:30	Session V: Key Issues, Gaps, Risks and Required Actions	All
4:30 - 4:50	Session VI: Action Planning and Next Steps - responsibilities, deadlines and document finalisation	Project Coordinator
4:50 - 5:00	Closing Remarks and Way Forward	UCC / UNAD / 8TECH